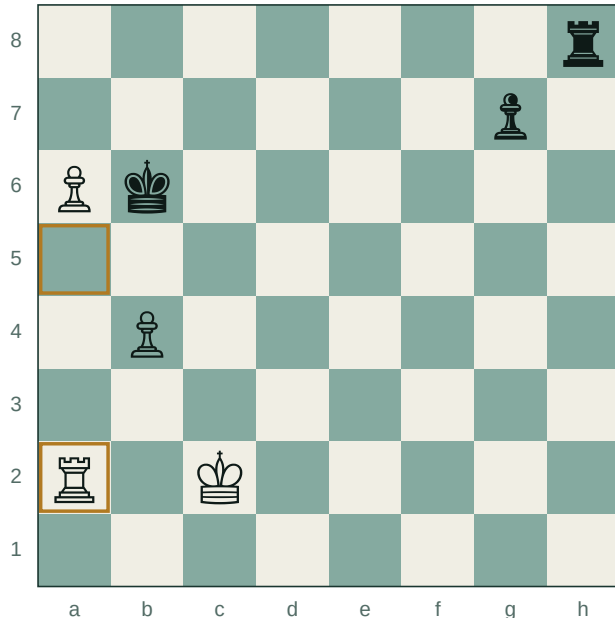


Active defensive resources: Black, move 49

Active defensive resources

Black to move



Previous move: 49.Ra2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

49...Rh2+ 50. Kb3 Rxa2 51. Kxa2 g5

49...Rh2+ Check restricts White to 6 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **50.Kb3**.

50...Rxa2 The rook captures the rook on a2. Recorded reply: **51.Kxa2**.

51...g5 The pawn moves from g7 to g5.

At the end, nominal material is White 2 / Black 1 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from -1 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on c2. Geometrically undefended: rook on a2. Check for tactical protection.